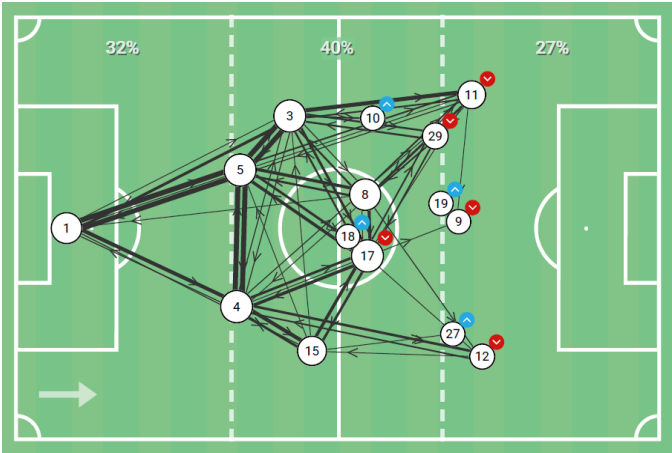


LEAD OPPONENT SCOUTING REPORT

Opponent: Michigan Wolverines
Date of Match: 10/31
Compiled By: Soham Mukherjee
Opponent Record: 10-2-3 in Fall 2025 (4-game win streak, most recently 4-0 win vs Detroit)

Overall Team Overview (over conference games):

Michigan plays with a balanced approach, averaging 49.04% possession, and typically builds through their back line with passing combinations. Their central midfielders (#8 and #17) link defense to attack with smart, progressive passes. Most of their open-play goals come from deliveries into the box, especially from their RW #12 (leading team with crosses (50) and assists (5)), or from over-the-top balls in transition releasing #9. Key threats include #9 (6 goals, 0 assists) and #11 (5 goals, 5 assists), both effective in and around the box. Attacking corner kicks, typically taken by #8 or #17, target aerial threats such as #9, #4, and #5, but may go short to outplay the opponent. Defensively, Michigan can be vulnerable in transition, often leaving gaps between defenders and struggling to recover numbers quickly. Recent goals conceded have come from opponents exploiting turnovers or counterattacks with quick passing and forward runs. Their man-oriented press can also pull players out of position, leaving open spaces that can be exploited by sharp movement and combination play.



Passing matrix vs Northwestern

PPDA	11.09	Higher PPDA against possession-focused opponents who dominate the game.
Average Possession %	49.04	Prefers to control the game on the ball but also capable of playing on the counterattack.
Passes per Possession	3.56	Balanced approach with medium passes through open channels, long balls into space.
Shots/crosses per 90	12/15	Defensive discipline can limit their effectiveness (39% shot, 35% cross accuracy)
xG per 90	1.71	High attacking output from passing play and clinical finishing in the box.

In Possession:

- Shape: 4-2-3-1 or 4-3-3
- During buildup, strong links between back line and CMs (#8, #17); GK often involved
- Attacking shape may look 3-2-5 with advanced RB
- Key attacking patterns: crosses from right side; through balls centrally; target runs by #9, #11

Out of Possession:

- Shape: 4-2-3-1 with high block
- Moderate press (PPDA ~11.09) with man-to-man tendencies
- Vulnerable in defensive transitions; slow to recover and susceptible to long balls and runners exploiting central gaps

Key Players:

- #9 – Grayson Elmquist (ST)
 - Target striker, aerial and physical threat
 - Good movement and finishing in the box
- #11 – Michael Ramirez (LW)
 - Quick dribbler and progressive passer
 - Effective attacking weak side and finishing crosses